Manuscript Submission & Publication System

Business Requirements Document (v1.1 - Final for client approval)

Document Control	
Client	Shri Ramswaroop Memorial University (SRMU)
Project	Online manuscript submission, review and publication system for SRMU journals (IJMAR and IJSPAST)
Prepared by	Himanshu Agrahari, Business Analyst, SRDT
Version / Status	v1.1 - Final, for client approval
Date	15 October 2026
Sources	Client's 12-step outline; existing form screenshot; client calls of 8 and 10 Oct 2026 (recording, meeting notes); client replies on ORCID, login and fee calculation; client confirmations (Sections 20 to 22); formats shared by the client (acknowledgement email, review form, invoice); client reply to the email notification list

Version	Date	Change
v0.1	07 Oct 2026	First draft from the 12-step outline and form screenshot
v0.2	08 Oct 2026	Two journals, journal-wise editors, reviewer view, editor-driven communication
v1.0	10 Oct 2026	Complete BRD after the detailed discussion: limits, time limits, reviewer registration, payment, reminders, publication Added ORCID author verification; submit-first with automatic account creation; payment changed so the page count is entered earlier and the amount is calculated by the system; added screen-wise details, status model, exception flows, data model, integrations, reports and acceptance scenarios.
v1.1	15 Oct 2026	Final for approval: client confirmations (Sections 20 to 22); paper ID format corrected to IJMAR01-DDMMYY; a resubmitted paper keeps its paper ID; client formats added (review form, acknowledgement email, invoice); ORCID mandatory with flag only; push-back limit 2; sign-off section added

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This document describes what the system must do to take a research paper from submission to online publication for two SRMU journals. It is written for the client to confirm and for the development team to use as the base for the functional specification (FSD).

1.2 Background

Only a static submission form exists today (srmu-journal-new.netlify.app/submit). After the author clicks submit nothing happens. The client wants the complete process behind the form, in 12 steps, with the editor controlling all communication.

1.1 Objectives

- One application for both journals with the same process.
- Genuine authors: the author's ORCID ID is verified before the paper reaches the editor.
- Author, editor and reviewer each see only what they need; author and reviewer never know each other.
- Every action is recorded with date and time; fixed time limits with warnings and reminders.
- Payment of the publication charge online, with an invoice and receipt, before publication.

2. Scope

Item	Details
In scope	Submission with ORCID verification; automatic account creation; paper ID; acknowledgement; editor screening; reviewer registration and selection; review and re-review; comment passing; author revision; final decision; camera-ready; editing and proofreading; fee calculation, invoice and payment; online publication; notifications and reminders; status trail; dashboards and basic reports
Already available	The submission form fields (Section 8.1)
Out of scope (this phase)	Payment waiver, refund and late-payment penalty (client: not needed); indexing; archive migration
Not discussed yet	Volume and issue numbering (Section 22).

3. Journals and Paper ID

Item	Details
Journals	IJMAR and IJSPAST. One application serves both; the author selects the journal.
Process	Same 12-step process for both journals.
Editors	One editor per journal, each with own login and own journal email (two editors). Notifications go to the editor of the paper's journal.
Paper ID	IJSPAST01-DDMMYY and IJMAR01-DDMMYY . The number is a daily sequence: it starts at 01 each day and increases for each manuscript received that day (five papers on one day end at 05; the next day restarts at 01). Example: the third IJMAR paper on 10 Oct 2026 is IJMAR03-101026. The sequence is kept separately for each journal. A resubmitted paper keeps its original paper ID (after a push-back or after a rejection); it never receives a new ID. The trail keeps the full history under the one ID.

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4. Roles and Permissions

Role	Login	Responsibility
Author (corresponding)	Account created automatically at submission; password set through a link sent with the acknowledgement	Submits, verifies ORCID, replies to comments, uploads revised and camera-ready papers, proofreads, pays
Editor (one per journal)	Own login and own journal email	Screens, rejects or pushes back, registers and selects reviewers, passes comments, takes the final decision, formats the final paper, enters the page count, publishes
Reviewer (2 per paper)	Login created at registration by the editor; sent when the paper is forwarded	Downloads the paper, fills the review form, rechecks the author's reply
Admin (Proposed)	Own login	Maintains journals, fee rules, templates, time limits and email texts; no role in individual papers
System	-	Paper ID, emails, reminders, status, trail, ORCID check, fee calculation, payment verification, invoice

Identity rule (double-blind): author and reviewers do not know each other. The editor is the only link. Reviewer names are never shown to the author; author details are never shown to the reviewers.

4.1 Permission matrix

Action	Author	Editor	Reviewer	Admin
Submit paper, upload revision and camera-ready	Yes	-	-	-
View own paper and status	Yes	-	-	-
View all papers of own journal	-	Yes	-	-
View full trail with dates	-	Yes	-	-
Push back, reject, forward	-	Yes	-	-
Register and select reviewers	-	Yes	-	-
View assigned paper and review form	-	-	Yes (assigned only)	-
Pass comments to author	-	Yes	-	-
Enter page count, publish	-	Yes	-	-
Pay the charge, download invoice	Yes	View	-	-
Edit fee rules, limits, templates	-	-	-	Yes

5. End-to-End Process

Step	What happens	Actor	System behaviour	Status
1	Author fills the form, selects the journal, verifies the ORCID iD (Section 6) and submits.	Author	Validates fields and file; runs the ORCID check; saves.	Submitted
2	Paper ID is generated and the author account is created. Acknowledgement email with paper ID and a set-password link goes to the author; a notice with the paper ID goes to the journal's editor.	System	Creates ID and account; sends two emails.	Acknowledged
3	Editor logs in, sees the ORCID status, checks the paper and either forwards it or pushes it back with a comment. If the paper is rejected, the author may resubmit it later under the same paper ID; Day 0 restarts and the trail is kept.	Editor	Push Back with comment box; Forward; Reject.	Under Screening / Pushed Back / Rejected

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Step	What happens	Actor	System behaviour	Status
4	Editor registers two reviewers (if new) in the Reviewer Registration tab, selects them and sends. Each reviewer gets an email with login.	Editor	Reviewer database; dropdown or search; login creation; email.	Sent to Reviewers
5	Each reviewer downloads the paper, fills the review form, submits and presses OK.	Reviewer	Shows only the paper and the blank review form.	Review Received
6	Editor sees both reviews in one trail, selects the comments to pass on and sends them to the author.	Editor	Trail; select and send; email to author.	Comments Sent
7	Author prepares a reply, edits details if needed (for example the title) and submits the revised paper (PDF or Word).	Author	Accepts reply and file; email to editor.	Revision Received
8	Editor checks and forwards the revised paper. Each reviewer rechecks and sends a final recommendation (maximum two reviews per reviewer).	Editor, Reviewer	Reviewer sees only own earlier review and the new one.	Re-review / Reviews Complete
9	Editor takes the final decision, notes a comment and informs the author.	Editor	Acceptance email.	Accepted / Rejected
10	Author uploads the camera-ready paper (Word).	Author	Upload; email to editor.	Camera-Ready Received
11	Editor formats the paper offline into the template and uploads it with the final page count. The system calculates the charge. The author sees the paper and the invoice preview and presses OK or Changes Needed (comment box and upload). Repeats until OK, maximum 5 times.	Editor, Author, System	Fee calculation; two buttons; amount recalculated at each upload.	Proofreading / Changes Requested
12	On OK the amount is frozen and the invoice is created at once. The author pays online; the system verifies automatically and sends the receipt. The editor publishes the paper.	Author, System, Editor	Payment gateway; invoice; auto-verification.	Payment Pending / Paid / Published

6. Author Verification through ORCID

The client wants the system to check, through the ORCID iD, that the author is genuine. The form already has an ORCID field. **Client decisions:** the ORCID iD is mandatory for submission and is supplied by the corresponding author; the system verifies it, and a Not verified result is only flagged to the editor (no blocking). The design below describes how the check works.

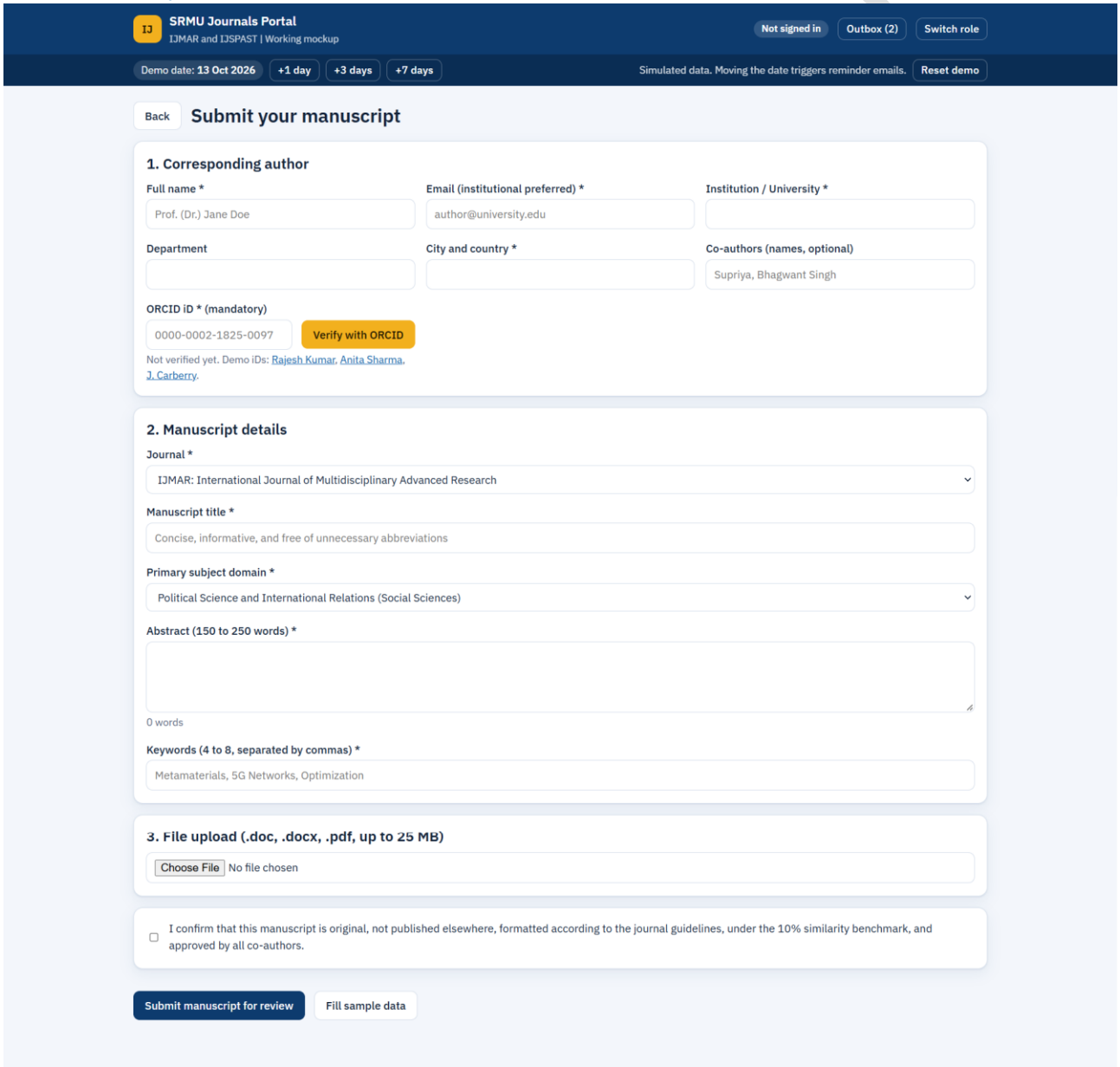
Point	Design
When	On the submission form, before the paper is saved.
Method	A Verify with ORCID button sends the author to ORCID to sign in. ORCID returns the iD and the name on the record. Because the author signs in at ORCID, this proves he or she owns the iD.
Method (fallback)	If the author types the iD only: the system checks the format and check digit, and then that the iD exists on the public ORCID registry. This shows the iD is real, but not that it belongs to the person submitting.
Name match	The name returned by ORCID is compared with the full name on the form. Small differences (initials, order, titles such as Dr.) are tolerated.
Result	Verified, Not verified (iD exists but name or ownership not proven) or Invalid (wrong format or not found).
On failure	Invalid: the author must correct the iD. Not verified: the paper is accepted and marked clearly for the editor, who decides (flag only, confirmed by the client).
Editor view	ORCID iD, a link to the public ORCID record and the Verified / Not verified badge, shown on the paper screen. Reviewers do not see it.

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Point	Design
Repeat authors	The verified iD is stored on the author account and reused. The same iD used by a different email is flagged to the editor.
Co-authors	Not covered by the current form. Co-author ORCID checks are out of scope unless the client asks.
Needed	ORCID API credentials for the application, registered for the SRMU domain. ORCID is mandatory (client); the form field becomes compulsory.

7. Functional Requirements

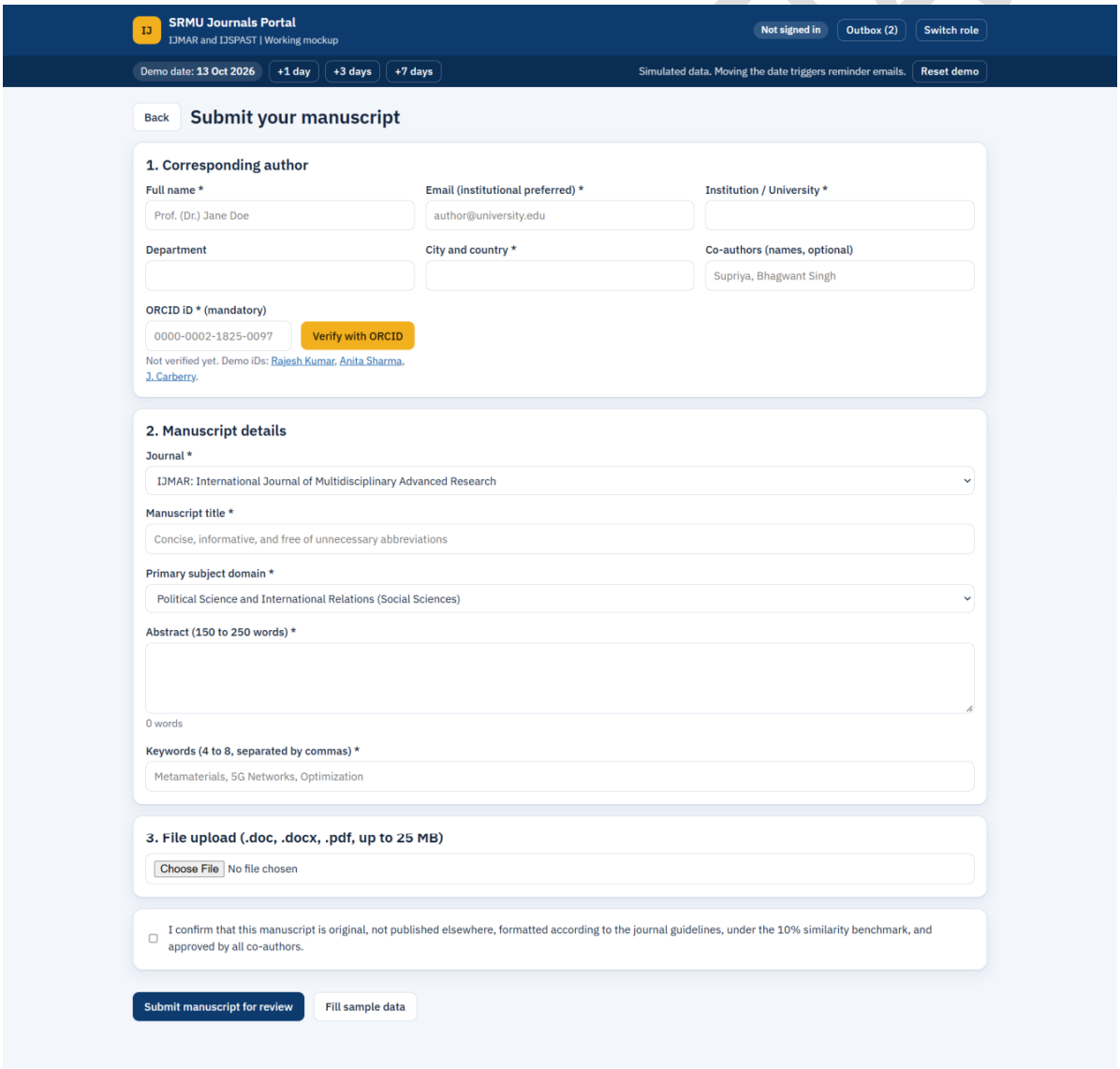
7.1 Submission, ORCID and author account



ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-01	The form shall validate mandatory fields, abstract length (150-250 words), keywords (4-8), file type (.doc, .docx, .pdf) and size (25 MB), and shall include a journal selector.	Must

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-02	The system shall verify the ORCID iD as described in Section 6 and store the result (Verified, Not verified, Invalid) with the paper.	Must
FR-03	The system shall generate the paper ID as JOURNAL + daily sequence + DDMMYY; the sequence restarts at 01 each day for each journal.	Must
FR-04	On submission the system shall create an author account from the email (or attach the paper to the existing account of that email).	Must
FR-05	The acknowledgement email shall carry the paper ID, the application link and a time-limited set-password link, not a plain password. The link can be re-sent.	Must
FR-06	The system shall send a notice with the paper ID and the ORCID status to the editor of the selected journal.	Must
FR-07	The author shall see status, comments, files and trail of own papers after login.	Should

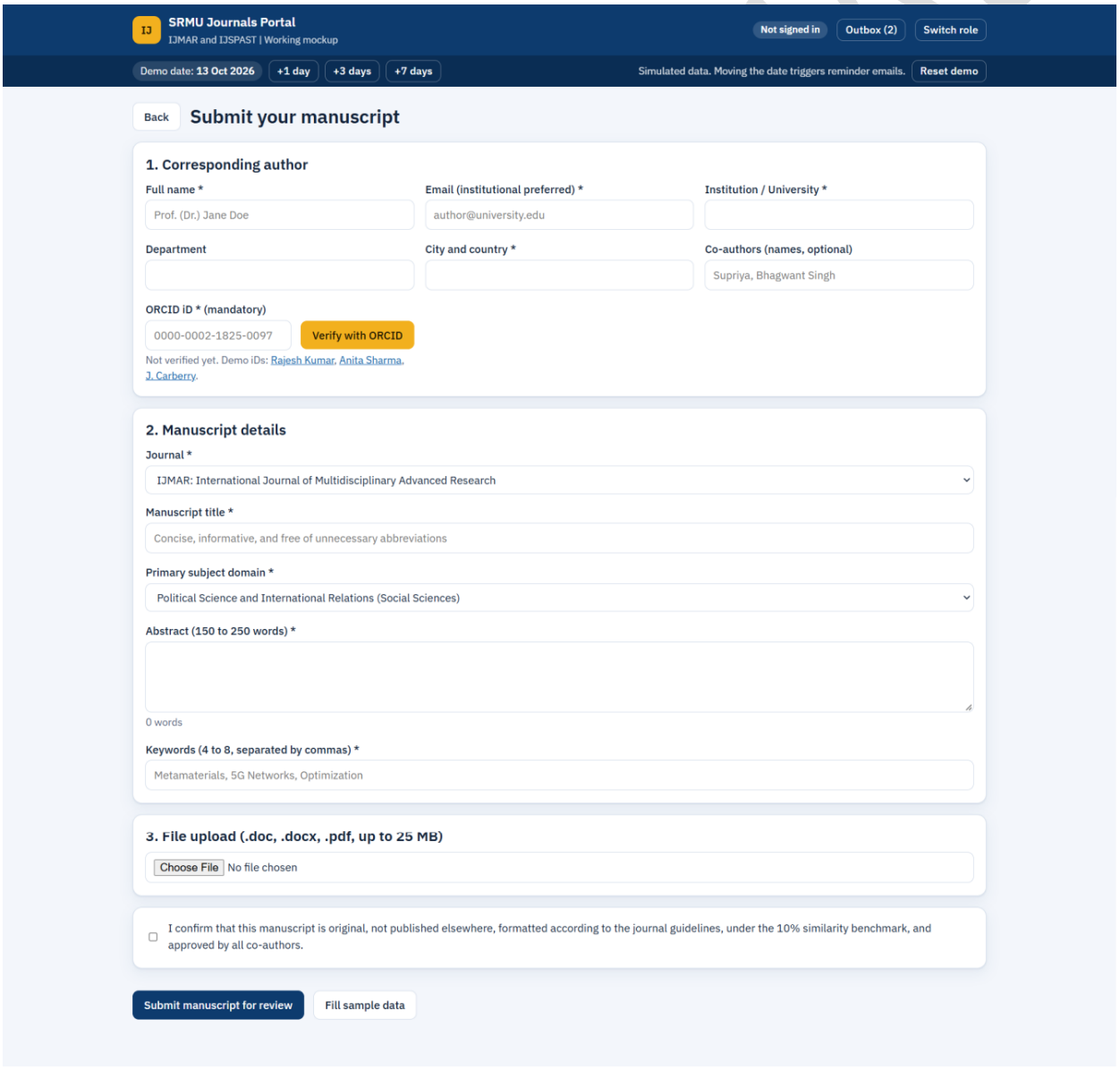
7.2 Editor



ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-08	Each journal has its own editor login and email; the editor sees only papers of that journal.	Must

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-09	The editor shall see the submitted details, file and ORCID status, and shall have Forward, Push Back and Reject actions.	Must
FR-10	Push Back shall open a comment box for the reason; the comment goes to the author.	Must
FR-11	The editor screen shall show a mail-style trail: submission, revisions, reviewer comments, replies, with date and time. Only the editor sees the complete trail.	Must
FR-12	The editor shall select which reviewer comments to pass on and send them to the author.	Must
FR-13	The editor shall take the final decision with a comment; the author is notified.	Must
FR-14	The editor shall download the camera-ready Word file, format it offline and upload the formatted file.	Must
FR-15	The editor shall publish the paper after payment.	Must

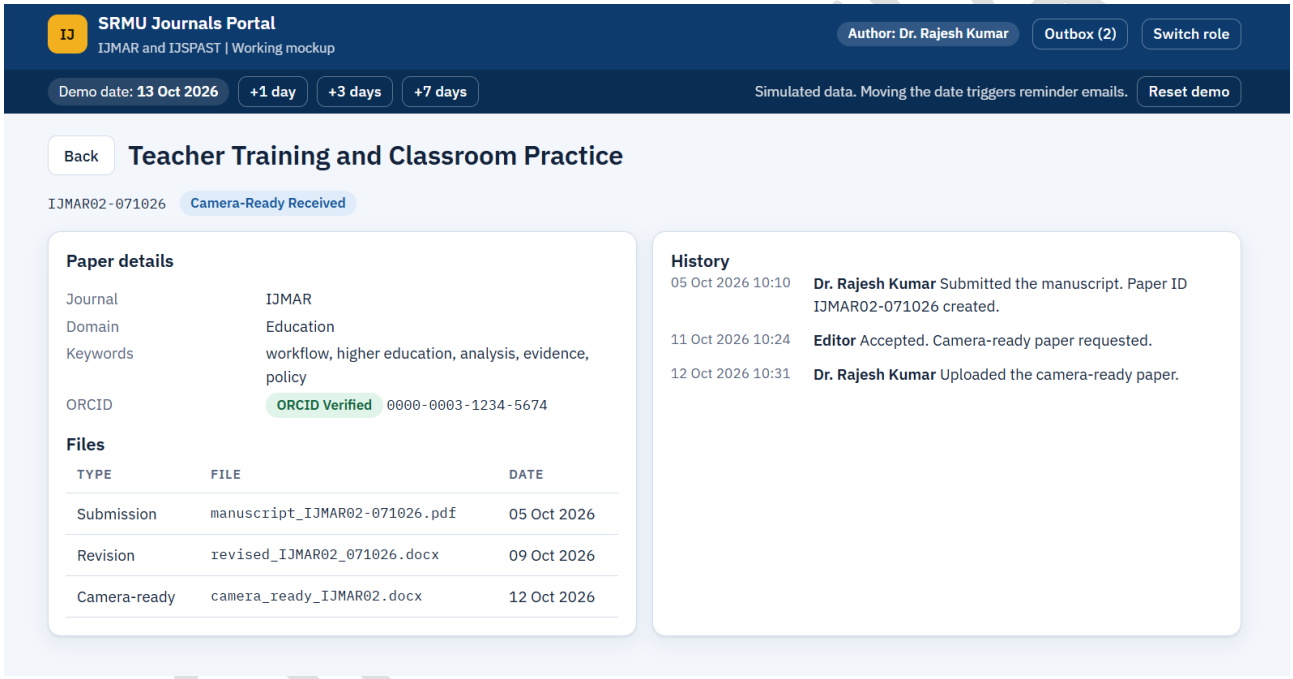
7.3 Reviewer registration and review



ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-16	The editor screen shall have a Reviewer Registration tab (name, email, phone and other mandatory details). Saving creates the reviewer login and stores the reviewer in the database.	Must

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-17	The editor shall select exactly two reviewers from the saved list (dropdown or search). Reviewers can differ for each paper.	Must
FR-18	On sending, each reviewer receives an email with the login; no separate registration by the reviewer.	Must
FR-19	The reviewer shall see only the paper (with download) and the client's review form, and shall submit it with OK.	Must
FR-20	On re-review the reviewer shall see only own earlier review, the author's reply and the revised paper.	Must
FR-21	Each reviewer can review a paper at most twice (first review and one recheck). The second carries the final recommendation.	Must
FR-22	Author and reviewers shall never see each other's identity.	Must

7.4 Revision, camera-ready and proofreading



ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-23	The author shall reply to comments, edit fields such as the title, and upload the revised paper (PDF or Word).	Must
FR-24	After acceptance the author shall upload the camera-ready paper in Word, in the journal template supplied by the client.	Must
FR-25	When the editor uploads the formatted paper, the editor shall enter the final page count; the system shall calculate the charge and show an invoice preview to the author next to the OK button.	Must
FR-26	The author shall have two buttons: OK and Changes Needed. Changes Needed opens a comment box and an upload button.	Must
FR-27	If the page count changes in a later round, the editor re-enters it and the amount is recalculated. The amount is frozen only when the author presses OK.	Must
FR-28	The editor-author proofreading loop continues until OK, with a maximum of 5 exchanges.	Must

7.5 Fee calculation, invoice and payment

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-29	The system shall keep a fee rule per journal (Admin): pages included in the base fee, base amount, charge per extra page, currency and GST. Values come from the client.	Must
FR-30	The charge shall be calculated by the system from the page count entered by the editor. The editor may override the amount with a reason, which is recorded.	Must
FR-31	When the author presses OK the amount shall be frozen and the invoice created immediately, with the paper ID, title, pages and amount. The author gets a notice and a Pay Now button; the editor is notified.	Must
FR-32	The author shall pay online through the payment gateway. The Article Processing Charge is a one-time payment per paper.	Must
FR-33	The system shall verify payment automatically, mark the paper Paid, send the receipt to the author and notify the editor.	Must
FR-34	A Payment Pending option with the amount shall stay visible to the author until payment is made.	Must
FR-35	Failed or interrupted payments shall be retried safely and never create two invoices or two payments (Section 12).	Must
FR-36	Payments of each journal shall be kept separate (to be confirmed).	Should

7.6 Publication

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-37	After payment the editor shall publish the paper on the journal website.	Must
FR-38	The paper page shall show the details on the page, with the full paper to view online or download as PDF. The display format is prepared by the technical team.	Must

7.7 Reminders, tracking and administration

ID	Requirement	Priority
FR-39	No button shall be blocked after a time limit. The system shall show a warning banner with days left on every page of the pending user and send warning and reminder emails (Section 10).	Must
FR-40	Phone reminders (SMS or similar) where possible; to be confirmed.	Could
FR-41	The system shall record date, time, user and action for every step.	Must
FR-42	The Admin shall maintain journals, time limits, fee rules, email texts and templates without code changes. (Proposed)	Should

8. Screen-wise Details

A first list of screens and fields, to be refined in the FSD. Fields not yet supplied by the client are marked.

8.1 Submission form (existing, with additions)

Section	Fields	Mandatory
Corresponding author	Full Name, Email, Institution, Department, City and Country, ORCID iD with Verify with ORCID button	All except Department; ORCID to be decided
Manuscript details	Journal (new), Title, Primary Subject Domain, Abstract (150-250 words), Keywords (4-8)	All
File upload	.doc / .docx / .pdf, up to 25 MB	Yes

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Section	Fields	Mandatory
Declaration	Original work, not published elsewhere, journal format, under 10% similarity, approved by co-authors	Yes

8.2 Other screens

Screen	Contents
Set password	Opened from the email link: new password, confirm, rules, expiry message with a re-send option.
Author dashboard	List of own papers: paper ID, title, journal, status, days left, next action button. Paper page: files, comments, trail visible to the author, warning banner.
Author reply screen	Editor's comments, reply text box, editable title and details, upload of revised file (PDF or Word), Submit.
Camera-ready upload	Journal template link, upload (Word), Submit.
Proofreading screen	Formatted paper (view and download), invoice preview (pages, amount), buttons OK and Changes Needed; Changes Needed shows comment box and upload.
Payment screen	Invoice (paper ID, title, pages, amount, GST), Pay Now, payment status, receipt and invoice download.
Editor dashboard	Papers of the journal in tabs by status, with search and filters, days in current step and overdue marks.
Editor paper screen	Submitted details, ORCID badge and link, files, full mail-style trail, action buttons for the current step.
Reviewer Registration tab	Name, email, phone and other mandatory details (to be fixed with the client), Save. List of saved reviewers with search.
Forward to reviewers	Two dropdown or search boxes for reviewers, Send.
Reviewer dashboard	Assigned papers, days left, Download button.
Review form	Client's format (to be supplied): fields, scores, recommendation, comments. Submit and OK.
Comment passing	Both reviews listed; editor selects the comments to pass on; Send to author.
Final edit and fee	Upload formatted file, final page count, calculated amount, override with reason, Send to author.
Published paper page	Details, view online, download PDF.
Admin settings (Proposed)	Journals, editors, fee rules, time limits, email texts.

8.3 Invoice and receipt fields

Invoice number, date, journal, paper ID, paper title, author name and email, number of pages, charge breakdown (base, extra pages), GST, total, payment reference and status. The format will be supplied by the client.

8.2 Review form (client format)

The review form below was supplied by the client and is built into the reviewer screen. Each point is rated 1 (Poor), 2 (Satisfactory), 3 (Good), 4 (Very Good) or 5 (Excellent).

No.	Criterion (rate 1 to 5)
1	Relevance and significance of the topic
2	Originality of the paper
3	Clarity of research objectives
4	Clarity and quality of literature review
5	Suitability and rigor of methodology

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No.	Criterion (rate 1 to 5)
6	Appropriateness of analysis and interpretation
7	Support for conclusion by results
8	Organization and clarity of writing
9	Quality and relevance of references
10	Quality of tables, and figures
11	Ethical and reporting standards

Part	Details
Recommendation to the Editor	Select one: Accept; Accept with minor revisions; Revise and resubmit / major revisions; Reject.
Confidential Comments to the Editor	Free text; never shown to the author.
Comments to the Authors	Free text; the editor selects what to pass on, as received, labelled Reviewer 1 and Reviewer 2.

9. Status Model

Status	Meaning	Next possible status
Submitted	Form saved	Acknowledged
Acknowledged	Paper ID and emails sent	Under Screening
Under Screening	With the editor (7 days)	Pushed Back, Rejected, Sent to Reviewers
Pushed Back	Returned to the author with a reason (maximum 2 times)	Under Screening (author resubmits, same paper ID)
Rejected	Rejected with a reason; the author may resubmit under the same paper ID	Under Screening (resubmission)
Sent to Reviewers	Both reviewers have the paper	Review Received
Review Received	A review is in (x of 2)	Comments Sent
Comments Sent	Editor passed comments to the author	Revision Received
Revision Received	Author replied	Re-review
Re-review	Reviewers rechecking	Reviews Complete
Reviews Complete	Final recommendations in	Accepted, Rejected
Accepted	Editor accepted	Camera-Ready Received
Camera-Ready Received	Author uploaded final paper	Proofreading
Proofreading	Formatted paper with the author (2 days)	Changes Requested, Payment Pending
Changes Requested	Author wants changes (max 5 exchanges)	Proofreading
Payment Pending	Invoice created; author to pay (2 days)	Paid
Paid	Payment verified	Published
Published	Live on the website	-

10. Time Limits and Reminders

Day 0 is the submission day. Limits are counted from the previous step and used for warnings and tracking, not for blocking.

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#	Step	Time limit	Owner
1	Editor reviews the paper and rejects or forwards it	Within 7 days of Day 0	Editor
2	If rejected, the author may resubmit under the same paper ID; Day 0 restarts	-	Author
3	Reviewers submit the first review	Minimum 7, maximum 14 days (7 normal + 7 extended)	Reviewer
4	Editor sends comments to the author	Within 2 days (2 to 3)	Editor
5	Author replies with the revised paper	7 days	Author
6	Editor forwards the reply to the reviewers	Within 2 days	Editor
7	Reviewers recheck and give the final recommendation	Minimum 2, maximum 4 days	Reviewer
8	Editor sends the acceptance acknowledgement	Within 2 days	Editor
9	Editor formats the paper and enters the page count	Within 7 days	Editor
10	Author proofreads and presses OK or Changes Needed	2 days (each round)	Author
	Time limit for the author's camera-ready upload	Within 7 days	Author
11	Invoice is created at once on OK	Automatic	System
12	Author pays	Within 2 days of the invoice	Author
13	Editor publishes the paper	After payment	Editor

10.1 Reminder schedule (Proposed)

When	What
Step starts	Email to the person who must act (this is the normal notification).
Half of the time limit passed (limits of 7 days or more)	Reminder email and banner.
1 day before the due date	Warning email, banner shows "1 day left"; phone message if enabled.
Due date	Warning email stating the limit is reached.
After the due date	Reminder every 2 days; the editor sees overdue marks on the dashboard and gets a list of overdue papers.

11. Business Rules and Limits

Rule	Decision
Reviewers per paper	Exactly 2, for both journals.
Reviewer reviews	Maximum 2 per reviewer (first review and one recheck).
Editor push-back before review	Maximum 2 times (confirmed by the client).
Proofreading exchanges	Maximum 5 between editor and author, until OK.
Communication	Only through the editor; no direct contact between author and reviewer.
Blocking	No blocking after a deadline; warnings and reminders only.
Payment	One-time APC after proofreading is approved. No waiver, refund or penalty in this phase.
Fee	Calculated by the system from the page count; editor may override with a reason.
ORCID	Mandatory for submission. Verified by the system; a Not verified result is only flagged to the editor, it does not block the paper (Section 6).
File formats	PDF during review; Word for camera-ready; both allowed for revisions.

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Rule	Decision
Resubmission and paper ID	A resubmitted paper (after push-back or after rejection) keeps the same paper ID. Day 0 restarts on resubmission after rejection; the earlier history stays in the trail.
Rejection after review	The editor rejects if any one of the reviewers rejects. At screening the editor can reject, for example when the similarity percentage is too high and no new results are discussed.
Similarity check	Done manually by the editor (client).
DOI	Obtained by SRMU; the system only stores and shows it.
Foreign authors	GST and currency for foreign authors are out of scope for now (client).

12. Exception and Alternate Flows

Situation	Handling
ORCID invalid	Author is asked to correct the iD before submitting.
ORCID not verified	Paper is saved and marked for the editor (to be confirmed).
Email already has an account	Paper is attached to that account; no new password mail; email says to log in.
Set-password link expired	Author requests a new link from the login page.
Wrong file type or file above 25 MB	Message shown; submission not saved.
Same title and author submitted twice (Proposed)	Warning to the author; editor sees a duplicate mark.
Reviewer does not respond	Reminders as in Section 10.1; the editor can select another reviewer (Proposed).
Reviewer declines (Proposed)	Editor selects another reviewer from the list.
Author does not reply in time	Reminders and banner; no blocking; the editor decides how to proceed.
Reviewer disagreement	If any one reviewer rejects, the editor rejects the paper (client). Otherwise the editor decides after both final recommendations.
Author resubmits after rejection	Same paper ID; status returns to Under Screening; Day 0 restarts; reviewers and earlier reviews are archived in the trail; the editor is notified.
Author resubmits after push-back	Same paper ID; status returns to Under Screening; editor notified.
Editor push-back limit reached (2)	The system stops further push-back and the editor must forward or reject.
Proofreading exchanges reach 5	The system flags the paper to the editor for a decision (Proposed).
Page count changes after a Changes Needed round	The editor re-enters the count; the amount is recalculated before the next OK.
Payment fails or is cancelled	Invoice stays Pending; the Pay button stays active so the author can retry; no second invoice.
Payment done but gateway reply lost	Status is checked with the gateway later and corrected automatically; no double payment.
Editor changes the amount	Allowed with a reason; recorded in the trail and shown on the invoice.

13. Notifications

Email formats are to be supplied by the client; SRDT will share the full draft list. Editor emails go to the editor of the paper's journal.

#	Trigger	To	Main content
1	Submission received	Author	Paper ID, application link, set-password link
2	Submission received	Editor	Paper ID, title, ORCID status
3	Paper pushed back	Author	Reason from the editor

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#	Trigger	To	Main content
4	Paper rejected	Author	Decision
5	Paper forwarded	Reviewers	Paper notice, login
6	Review submitted	Editor	Which reviewer, paper ID
7	Comments passed on	Author	Comments, reply deadline
8	Revised paper submitted	Editor	Paper ID
9	Revised paper forwarded	Reviewers	Reply and revised paper
10	Acceptance	Author	Decision, camera-ready request
11	Camera-ready received	Editor	Paper ID
12	Formatted paper ready	Author	Proofreading request, invoice preview
13	Author pressed OK or Changes Needed	Editor	Choice and comments
14	Invoice created	Author	Amount, Pay Now link
15	Payment received	Author, Editor	Receipt, invoice
16	Paper published	Author	Link to the paper
17	Reminders and warnings	Author, Editor, Reviewer	Days left, action needed

13.1 Acknowledgement email (client format)

Sent when the paper is submitted, to the corresponding author **and** to the journal official email (for example editor@ijspast.com).

Part	Content
Subject	[Journal] Journal: Paper Receipt Acknowledgement [Paper ID] (example: IJSPAST Journal: Paper Receipt Acknowledgement IJSPAST01-141026)
Body	Dear Corresponding Author, we have properly received the submission of the paper: Title; by [author names]. The paper id assigned to your paper is [Paper ID]. Please refer to this id in all correspondence. You can check the status of your manuscript at the author center: log in Journal website. We will let you know about the decision from our Editorial Board as soon as possible. Thank you for the submission of your paper to our journal.
Signature	Yours sincerely, Editor-in-Chief and the two Deputy Editors-in-Chief (IJSPAST: Prof. Vijay Tiwari, Prof. Nabeel Ahmad, Prof. Alkesh Agrawal), on behalf of the [Journal] Editorial and Production Office, with the journal email address.
Added by the system	For a new author: the set-password link. IJMAR signatories and website address to be supplied by the client (Section 22).

The client also confirmed the other notification emails. Key client points: the push-back email carries the editor's reason; reviewer comments are passed on as received (Reviewer 1 and Reviewer 2, no names); the author's reply is point-wise; Changes Needed is a new file with the changes highlighted; the Pay button stays active after a failed payment.

14. Payment and Fee Details

Point	Details
Type	Article Processing Charge (APC), one-time payment per paper.
Fee logic	Page-wise: a base amount up to a page limit and an extra amount for each additional page, with GST. Example only (client invoice sample, not real fees): a fixed charge up to a page limit, then a rate per extra page. Real amounts per journal come from the client.
Who enters what	The editor enters the final page count when uploading the formatted paper. The system calculates the amount. The editor can override it with a reason.

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Point	Details
Why changed	The client's flow had the editor calculate after the author's OK, which makes the author wait and leaves the calculation to manual work. With the page count entered earlier, the invoice is ready the moment the author presses OK.
Author view	Invoice preview next to the OK button; Pay Now after OK.
Verification	Automatic by the system.
Invoice and receipt	Required, kept in the journal's and the author's records. Format from the client.
Gateway and account	Not decided; the client (Ritesh sir) will decide, SRDT will suggest. Journal money kept separate.
Waiver, refund, penalty	Not needed in this phase.

14.1 Invoice format (client format)

The invoice follows the client's APC invoice. **The amounts shown are examples only, not real fees.** Real fee rules come from the client (Section 22).

Part	Content
Header	Journal name and full title; [Journal] Editorial and Production Office; journal website
Title block	INVOICE; Date; Invoice Number (numeric, for example 25101001); TO: author name and institution
Manuscript	Manuscript ID # (the paper ID, for example IJSPAST01-141026) and paper title
Table	Qty, Description, Rate, Amount (in Rs). Line 1: Fixed Paper Charge (upto N pages). Line 2: Overlength Page Charge (rate per extra page). Total APC. (Example: 5,000 fixed + 1,000 for two extra pages at 500 = 6,000.)
Payment	Scan the QR code for APC payment. One QR code serves both journals (client).
Receipt	Issued automatically after the system verifies the payment.

15. Data Model (Business View)

Entity	Main information
Journal	Name, short code, editor, editor email, fee rule, template
User	Name, email, phone, role, password status, active flag
Author profile	Institution, department, city, country, ORCID iD, ORCID status, ORCID name
Reviewer	Name, email, phone, domain, registered by, active flag
Paper	Paper ID, journal, title, domain, abstract, keywords, author, status, Day 0 date, current step due date
Paper file	Paper, type (submission, revision, camera-ready, formatted), version, file, uploaded by, date
Review	Paper, reviewer, round (1 or 2), form answers, recommendation, date
Trail event	Paper, actor, action, comment, date and time
Notification log	Recipient, template, date, delivery status
Fee rule	Journal, base pages, base amount, extra page rate, currency, GST percent
Invoice	Invoice number, paper, pages, amount breakdown, status, date
Payment	Invoice, gateway reference, amount, status, date

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16. Integrations

System	Use
Email service	Acknowledgement, notifications, reminders, set-password links. Sent from the journal domain; editor mailboxes created by the client.
ORCID	Sign-in or lookup to verify the author's iD and name (Section 6).
Payment (QR code)	One QR code for both journals; the system verifies the payment automatically. Account details to be supplied by the client.
SMS or similar	Phone reminders: yes, provided the service is not chargeable (client). Service to be chosen.
Journal website	Published papers shown on the existing website; display format by the technical team.

17. Reports and Dashboards

Report	Contents
Editor dashboard	Papers by status, days in step, overdue list, ORCID status
Paper turnaround	Days taken in each step, per paper and on average
Reviewer workload	Papers per reviewer, pending and completed, average days
Payments	Invoices, paid and pending, amount per journal and period
Daily submissions	Papers received per day and journal

(Proposed) These are suggested; the client has not asked for reports yet.

18. Non-Functional Requirements

- Security: manuscripts and reviews are visible only to the roles allowed in Section 4.1; passwords are stored hashed; all pages use HTTPS.
- Privacy: author and reviewer identities are never shown to each other, including in file names, document properties and emails.
- Audit: every action is logged with user, date and time.
- Payments: card details are handled only by the gateway and never stored.
- Availability: the application should be available at all times, with daily backup of data and files (Proposed).
- Usability: works on desktop and mobile; clear messages for every error.
- Files: PDF, DOC and DOCX up to 25 MB.
- Email: sent from journal domain addresses; delivery failures are logged.
- Retention: papers, files and invoices are kept as per SRMU policy (to be confirmed).

19. Acceptance Scenarios

#	Scenario	Expected result
1	Author submits with a valid ORCID	Paper ID in the right format, account created, two emails sent, editor sees Verified
2	Three IJMAR papers on one day, then one next day	IJMAR01, 02, 03 on day one; IJMAR01 next day; IJSPAST counted separately
3	Author submits with an invalid ORCID	Submission blocked with a message
4	Same email submits a second paper	Attached to the same account; no new password mail
5	Editor pushes back with a reason	Author receives the reason; status Pushed Back
6	Editor forwards to two reviewers	Both receive login and notice; each sees only the paper and form
7	Reviewer tries to open another paper	Access denied

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#	Scenario	Expected result
8	Both reviews submitted	Editor sees both in the trail and passes selected comments
9	Author replies; reviewers recheck twice	Third review attempt not possible
10	Editor accepts	Author gets acceptance and camera-ready request
11	Editor uploads formatted file with 12 pages	Amount calculated from the fee rule; author sees the preview
12	Author presses Changes Needed with a file	Editor notified; after the new upload the amount is recalculated
13	Author presses OK	Amount frozen, invoice created at once, Pay Now shown
14	Payment succeeds	Auto-verified, receipt to author, notice to editor, status Paid
15	Payment fails	Invoice stays Pending; retry possible; no double invoice
16	Deadline passes	No button blocked; reminders sent; editor sees overdue mark
17	Editor publishes	Paper page shows details, view online and PDF download

20. Decisions Taken

#	Decision	Client response
1	Submit first with automatic account creation; page count entered by the editor with the formatted paper and the amount calculated by the system.	Confirmed (OK)
2	Paper ID: IJSPAST01-DDMMYY and IJMAR01-DDMMYY with a daily sequence. A resubmitted paper keeps its paper ID.	Confirmed (client corrected the format)
3	Two reviewers per paper, chosen domain-wise by the editor and registered in a separate tab.	Confirmed (OK)
4	Editor is the only link between author and reviewers; double-blind.	Confirmed (OK)
5	Time limits as in Section 10; no blocking; warnings and reminders.	Confirmed (OK)
6	Maximum 2 reviews per reviewer; maximum 5 proofreading exchanges.	Confirmed (OK)
7	APC one-time, page-wise; system verifies payment; invoice and receipt required; no waiver, refund or penalty.	Confirmed (OK)
8	Author is verified through the ORCID iD; ORCID is mandatory; flag only on Not verified.	Confirmed (OK)
9	Editor push-back before review: maximum 2 times.	Confirmed
10	One QR code for payment, for both journals.	Confirmed
11	Phone reminders: yes, if not chargeable. Reviewer login by email only. Reminder schedule and reports as proposed.	Confirmed
12	Similarity check done manually by the editor. DOI obtained by SRMU. Foreign-author GST and currency: out of scope for now.	Confirmed

21. Inputs Required from the Client

#	Item	Owner	Client response
1	Review form format	Deputy Director - Research	Shared (Section 8.2)
2	Acknowledgement email format and other notification formats	Deputy Director - Research	Shared (Section 13.1)
3	Camera-ready template with SRMU added	Deputy Director - Research	Shared
4	Invoice and receipt format	Deputy Director - Research	Shared (Section 14.1)
5	Payment gateway and receiving account for each journal	Deputy Director - Research	Will discuss with the Accounts Section and revert. One QR code for both journals

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#	Item	Owner	Client response
6	Fee rules per journal: page limit, base amount, extra-page rate, currency, GST	Deputy Director - Research	Will discuss and revert (invoice amounts are examples only)
7	Published paper display format	Technical team	Will share the format
8	ORCID rules and ORCID API registration	Deputy Director - Research	ORCID is mandatory for submission. API registration to follow

22. Open Items

Items answered by the client are recorded in Section 20. The items below are still open.

#	Open item	Owner	Priority
1	Real fee rules per journal (page limit, base amount, extra-page rate, GST), the QR code and the receiving account.	Client (with Accounts Section)	High
2	Published paper display format.	Technical team	Medium
3	Service for phone reminders (free of charge).	SRDT / Client	Medium

23. Assumptions, Dependencies and Risks

- The client supplies all formats (review form, notification emails, template, invoice) and the fee rules on time; delay here delays development.
- ORCID, payment gateway and email services are available and credentials are provided on time.
- The editor of each journal responds within the time limits; delays are handled by reminders, not blocking.
- The page count is entered by the editor, so the amount depends on the editor entering it correctly; the override reason is recorded.
- Authors with a name different from the ORCID record may be marked Not verified and need the editor's judgement.
- Phone reminders depend on an external service and may add cost.
- The payment gateway choice may add onboarding time.

Glossary

Term	Meaning
APC	Article Processing Charge, the one-time publication fee
BRD / FSD	Business Requirements Document / Functional Specification Document
Camera-ready	The final author version of the paper, ready to be formatted for publication
Double-blind	Author and reviewers do not know each other
ORCID iD	A unique 16-digit identifier of a researcher (format 0000-0000-0000-0000)
Day 0	The day the author submits the paper
Trail	The dated record of every action on a paper

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25. Approval and Sign-off

By signing below, the client confirms that this document (v1.1) is approved and will be used as the basis for the functional specification and development. The points mentioned in Section 22 will remain open and will be finalized through change notes without delaying the start of work. Any further changes to the approved requirements will be handled through a formal written change request.

Role	Name and designation	Signature	Date
Client approver	Honorable Vice Chancellor Prof. (Dr.) Vijay Tiwari		
Client reviewer	Deputy Director – Research Mr. Alkesh Aggarwal, SRMU		
Reviewer (SRDT)	Mr. Ritesh Khanna		15/10/2026
Reviewed by (SRDT)	Amit Kumar Singh		15/10/2026
Business Analyst (SRDT)	Himanshu Agrahari		15/10/2026

Approval by email reply stating “BRD v1.1 approved” is accepted in place of a signature

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